

STAGE THREE • JOB APPLICATION & INTERVIEW SKILLS

FIRSTS

DISCUSSION PROMPTS

Open-ended questions to seed group conversation beyond the worksheets

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Discussion Prompts

Stage Three • Job Application & Interview Skills

PURPOSE

Individual worksheets answer “what's your application strategy / STAR story / offer comparison?” These prompts answer a different question: “what's your real, lived experience of applying, interviewing, and deciding?” They're open-ended and personal, meant to seed conversation beyond a simple share-out of worksheet answers.

Use these during share-out portions, when a session finishes its planned agenda with time to spare, or when a group's energy needs a genuine, specific prompt rather than “any volunteers?” They're organized by session, four prompts each.

This stage in particular tends to surface real anxiety and real war stories — rejections, nerve-racking interviews, negotiations that felt uncomfortable. Give these prompts genuine room; they often produce the most useful peer learning in the whole stage.

Prompts by Session

SESSION 1

Building the Application

"What's a job listing you almost didn't apply to because you assumed you weren't qualified, but applied anyway? What happened?"

"Has tailoring a resume or cover letter to a specific listing ever actually changed the outcome for you, as far as you know?"

"What's a STAR story you're proud of that you almost didn't think to include?"

"How do you personally decide when a job listing's requirements are genuine must-haves versus a wish list?"

SESSION 2

Interview Readiness

"What's the most nervous you've ever been walking into an interview, and what got you through it?"

"Has a case or problem-solving interview ever gone in a direction you genuinely didn't expect? What did you do?"

"What's a piece of interview advice you've heard that you actually disagree with?"

"How do you feel about negotiating an offer — does it feel natural, or does it feel like you're pushing your luck?"

SESSION 3

Closing the Loop

"Do you have a genuine pre-interview routine, or does the nervous energy just happen to you?"

"Has a thank-you email ever led to a real, noticeable response or shift in how a process went?"

"What's the most disorganized your own application process has ever gotten, and what fixed it?"

"When comparing two real offers, what would make you choose the one with worse pay?"